



45-MINUTE INDOOR CYCLING · INSTRUCTOR GUIDE

SPINNING COURSE.

A bright, rehearsal-ready class plan with precise music timing, practical coaching language, and safety-first progression.

● Focus · strength · freedom

14 tracks · 44:56

Build confidence before intensity.



For a first course, the goal is not to exhaust the room. It is to create a ride that feels clear, safe, musical, and achievable. Every standing section is optional, and the instructor should coach effort—not force a fixed resistance.

2–3 Easy Full conversation	4 Comfortable Working pace	5–6 Moderate Talk, not sing	7–8 Hard Short phrases	9–10 Maximal Not used today
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The essential rule

Cadence and resistance work together. If a rider's hips bounce or the pedals feel uncontrolled, ask them to slow down or add a small amount of resistance.

Cadence ceiling

Keep sustained work under approximately **105–110 RPM**. Beginners should choose the highest cadence they can control with quiet hips and smooth pedal strokes.

Warm-up

Allow 5–10 minutes for heart rate and breathing to rise gradually. Start seated, light, and technically focused.

Cooldown

Reduce resistance and cadence gradually. Avoid an abrupt stop; let breathing settle before riders dismount.

Cue the change **before the music changes:
position → cadence → resistance → effort.**

First-timer safety note

Published case reviews show that severe exertional rhabdomyolysis has occurred disproportionately after first spinning sessions. Avoid maximal work. Stop for chest pain, faintness, severe weakness, or unusual breathlessness. Extreme thigh pain or dark urine after class requires urgent medical attention.

The rhythm ride.

A friendly first-class arc: three tracks to warm up, alternating cadence and climbing work, one controlled final build, then a calm finish. Standing is always optional.

0:00–2:46	Easy seated warm-up Posture, brake, resistance control	70–80 RPM	RPE 2–3
2:46–5:38	Progressive warm-up Add resistance gradually	75–85	RPE 3–4
5:38–8:42	Cadence preparation 3 × 20–30 sec controlled accelerations	80–90	RPE 4–5
8:42–11:57	Rolling road 1 min light / 1 min moderate	70–80	RPE 5–6
11:57–15:00	Seated climb Progressive resistance	60–70	RPE 6
15:00–18:09	Tempo road Smooth pedal stroke	75–85	RPE 5
18:09–20:58	Standing-climb introduction 20–30 sec up, then seated; optional	60–70	RPE 6
20:58–24:27	Speed intervals 30 sec quicker / 30 sec controlled	85–100	RPE 6–7
24:27–26:45	Active recovery Seated road and hydration	70–80	RPE 3–4
26:45–30:12	Progressive climb Optional standing finish	60–70	RPE 6–7
30:12–33:17	Cadence intervals 3 × 30 sec accelerations	85–100	RPE 7
33:17–36:18	Steady endurance Pressure through the full pedal stroke	75–85	RPE 5–6
36:18–40:26	Final controlled build Moderate → hard → recover, twice	75–90	RPE 6–8
40:26–44:56	Cooldown Lower cadence and resistance gradually	60–75	RPE 2–3

— Cadence / tempo — Resistance / climb — Warm-up / recovery

Spotify sequence.

Tap any track title in the PDF to open it in Spotify. Keep this exact order, turn Shuffle off, and rehearse every transition before teaching.

1	Good to Go LÒNIS, Daphne Willis · warm-up	2:46	2	I Feel Good Pitbull, Anthony Watts, DJ White Shadow	2:52
3	Alright, Alright, Alright Rayelle · cadence prep	3:04	4	That's What I Like (feat. Fitz) Flo Rida, Fitz · rolling road	3:15
5	I'll Be There — Cahill Remix Jess Glynne, Cahill · seated climb	3:03	6	Good To Be Alive Andy Grammer · tempo road	3:09
7	Yes Yes I Can Rayelle · standing introduction	2:49	8	I'm Coming Out / Upside Down Diana Ross, Chris Cox · speed intervals	3:29
9	Good Time — VIP Mix Jodie Harsh · active recovery	2:18	10	Shivers Ed Sheeran · progressive climb	3:27
11	Gonna Be a Good Day Rayelle · cadence intervals	3:05	12	Be Kind Zak Abel · steady endurance	3:01
13	Young Hearts Run Free Candi Staton · final build	4:08	14	Take Me To The Ocean The Movement · cooldown	4:30

Spotify setup: Shuffle OFF · Automix OFF · Crossfade 0–2 seconds. Download the tracks before class and keep a backup device/cable. Availability and clean/explicit versions can vary by country; confirm every track in the studio account.

Rolling hills + intervals.

A second structure for later classes. It feels more athletic but keeps the same beginner-safe principles: measured peaks, real recoveries, and a full five-minute cooldown.

0:00–6:00	6 min	Seated warm-up · posture and gradual resistance	70–85 RPM	
6:00–10:00	4 min	Cadence prep · 3 × 30 sec accelerations	85–95	
10:00–15:00	5 min	Progressive seated climb	60–70	
15:00–18:00	3 min	Flat-road recovery	75–85	
18:00–23:00	5 min	Rolling hills · 45 sec climb / 45 sec lighter	65–80	
23:00–26:00	3 min	Active recovery + hydration	70–80	
26:00–32:00	6 min	6 × 30 sec quicker / 30 sec controlled	85–100	
32:00–35:00	3 min	Recovery road	70–80	
35:00–40:00	5 min	Final climb · optional short standing sections	60–70	
40:00–45:00	5 min	Gradual cooldown + off-bike stretch	60–75	

Music energy map

1 · Welcome

Warm, familiar, low-pressure.

2 · Prepare

Clear beat, light lift in energy.

3 · Work

Heavy, driving tracks for hills.

4 · Release

Brighter, lighter recovery tracks.

5 · Peak

Fast intervals, then one emotional finale.

6 · Land

Calm final track, no abrupt stop.

Simple cues that land.

Before acceleration

"In ten seconds, keep your hips quiet and let the legs get a little quicker. Your resistance stays supportive."

Before a climb

"Add resistance in small steps. The road gets heavier, but your pedal stroke stays smooth."

Before standing

"Standing is optional. Add resistance first, then rise with your hips over the saddle and your hands light."

During recovery

"Keep the legs moving. Let your breath settle, relax your jaw, and take water if you need it."

When form slips

"If your hips are bouncing, add a touch of resistance or slow the legs. Control is the goal."

During the final effort

"Choose the strongest pace you can control today. This is hard, not reckless—leave room to finish well."

Pre-class checklist

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|---|---|
| ☐ Rehearse the entire playlist with a stopwatch. | ☐ Confirm clean/explicit versions in the studio account. |
| ☐ Test microphone, speaker level, and backup audio. | ☐ Learn the bike's brake and resistance controls. |
| ☐ Arrive early to help with saddle and handlebar setup. | ☐ Identify first-time riders and relevant injuries. |
| ☐ Explain RPE and that recovery is always allowed. | ☐ Make every standing section optional. |
| ☐ Keep water accessible and the room ventilated. | ☐ Never cue zero resistance or uncontrolled cadence. |
| ☐ Avoid push-ups, crunches, weights, and complex choreography. | ☐ End with a gradual cooldown before dismounting. |

The first-course objective

Riders should leave understanding the bike, trusting the instructor, and feeling successful enough to return—not wondering whether they survived.

Sources + responsible use.

American Heart Association — Warm Up, Cool Down

heart.org/.../warm-up-cool-down

Supports gradual 5–10 minute warm-ups and cooldowns rather than stopping suddenly.

Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — Measuring Physical Activity Intensity

cdc.gov/physical-activity-basics/measuring

Defines the 0–10 relative intensity scale and talk test used in this guide.

Indoor Cycling Association — Why Cadence Matters

indoorcyclingassociation.com/.../why-cadence-matters

Discusses cadence/resistance interaction, stable form, progressive cadence work, and an approximate 110 RPM ceiling.

Terry et al. (2020) — Effects of music in exercise and sport

doi.org/10.1037/bul0000216

Meta-analysis of 139 studies; music was associated with improved affect, performance, perceived exertion, and efficiency.

Masuda et al. (2023) — Exertional rhabdomyolysis after indoor spinning

pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/35254210

Systematic review of 97 reported patients; many were healthy women attending their first spinning session.

Chavarrias et al. (2019) — Health Benefits of Indoor Cycling

pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/31443139

Systematic review of indoor cycling's health and fitness effects.

Important: This document is an educational planning aid, not medical guidance and not a replacement for a recognized indoor-cycling instructor certification, CPR/AED training, the studio's emergency procedures, or participant screening. The instructor remains responsible for music licensing, local facility policy, bike setup, room conditions, and adapting the class to the people present.

Next rehearsal

Print pages 3–4, place them on the instructor console, and run the full 44:56 sequence twice: once for movement timing, once for cue timing and microphone practice.